lakh Aūzbegs. Ẕū’n-nūn Arghūn was eventually captured, and his head was chopped.

Mīrzās’ mothers, elder and younger sisters, wives and treasure were in Fort Ikhtiyāru’d-dīn at Ālā-qūrghān. The sluggish Mīrzās reached the town at night and let their horses rest till before resuming in the dawn. Look at the irony, they didn’t even think once to strengthen the fort and ran away leaving their mothers, sisters, wives and children for the Aūzbeg’s to capture.

Within Ālā-qūrghān, Sulṭān Ḥusaayn Mīrzā’s had a harem with Pāyanda Sulṭān Begum and Khadīja Begum heading it. The harems of Badī’u’z-zamān Mīrzāand Muẓaffar Mīrzā too were placed within this place along with their little children, treasure, and households.

Indeed, the Mīrzās had acted cowardly and foolishly by not securing the fort, and neither had any reinforcement arrived. But ‘Āshiq-i-muḥammad Arghūn, the younger brother of Mazīd Beg showed courage and fled from the army on foot to get into the fort. Amīr Umar Beg’s son, ‘Alī Khān (Turkmān), Shaikh ‘Abdu’l-lāh, Mīrzā Beg Kāī-khusraūī, and Mīrak Gūr the dīwān too barged into the fort to prepare it for the upcoming conflict.

Trouble arrived within three days—Shaybāni Khān had come. And with him had come treachery of the people. Many notables, including Shaikhu’l-islām came out in support of the Khān and handed over the keys of the outer fort. But there was one man, ‘Āshiq-i-muḥammad (discussed in the paragraph above), who had abandoned the Tīmūrids to save the fort. He held the fort for almost seventeen days and finally on the eighteenth day the breach occurred, when a mine was fired from the horse-market outside. It was devastating to see the watch tower fall.

The fort had fallen.

After Shaybāni Khān took Herī, he misbehaved with every woman and the children. His five days of stay had earned him a bad reputation, according to Babur. In his eyes, one of Shaybāni Khān’s first improper deeds in Herī was to make Khadīja Begum miserable. The despicable (in the eyes of Babur), paymaster Shāh Manṣūr, was tasked with holding her. He looted her in every way possible. Then Shaybāni Khān, let ‘Abdu’l-wahhāb Moghūl plunder the revered and virtuous Shaikh Pūrān. Each of his children was taken as a slave by someone or other. Shaybāni Khān got a band of poets detained by Mullā Banā’ī. This matter is well captured in a Persian verse and was quite well known in Khurāsān. [*]

Except ‘Abdu’l-lāh the stupid fool (kīr-khar),